

Binary polynomials vanishing to high order off the origin: the minimum degree at every origin order

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With substantial assistance from Claude and GPT models.
Details at the end of the main text.

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Abstract

For $0 \leq \ell < k$, let $\delta(n, k, \ell)$ be the least degree of a polynomial $P \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ that vanishes with (Hasse) multiplicity at least k at every nonzero point of $\mathbb{F}_2^n$ and with multiplicity exactly ℓ at the origin. We prove that for all $n \geq 1$,

$$\delta(n, k, \ell) = n + 2\ell + \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \left\lfloor \frac{k - \ell - 1}{2^j} \right\rfloor.$$

Menezes determined δ over every field for $k \geq 2$ and $n \geq k - 1$; in characteristic two his value is $n + 2k - 2 - s_2(k - \ell - 1)$, which our formula recovers whenever $k - \ell - 1 < 2^n$. When $k - \ell - 1 \geq 2^n$ the value is smaller: each block of 2^n in $k - \ell - 1$ is paid for by the square of the product of the affine forms $1 + u \cdot x$, $u \neq 0$, of the $2^n - 1$ hyperplanes avoiding the origin. The lower bound inverts $x^2 + x$ by an additive power series and reduces modulo the vanishing polynomial of the span of $x_1^2 + x_1, \dots, x_n^2 + x_n$. Minimizing over ℓ gives the least degree $D(n, k)$ of a polynomial with multiplicity at least k off the origin and less than k at the origin: $D(n, k) = 2k + n - 2 - \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor$ for $k < 2^{n-1}$, and $2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$ for $k \geq 2^{n-1}$. So the multiplicity Schwartz–Zippel bound $2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$, which Bishnoi, Boyadzhyska, Das and Mészáros asked about for $k \geq 2^{n-2}$, where their hyperplane covers attain it, is not attained for any $k < 2^{n-2}$. Both values hold over every field of characteristic two, by a descent to $\mathbb{F}_2$. Every theorem, lemma and corollary is formalized in Lean 4, and an appendix maps each to its formal proof.

1 Introduction

Polynomials that vanish to high order on a grid are a basic tool of the polynomial method. Over the Boolean cube a natural extremal question asks how small the degree of such a polynomial can be when it is required to vanish to order k everywhere except at one point. Over $\mathbb{R}$ this question was answered by Sauerermann and Wigderson [SW20]: the least degree of $P \in \mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ with $P(\mathbf{0}) \neq 0$ and zeros of multiplicity at least $k \geq 2$ at all other points of $\{0, 1\}^n$ is $n + 2k - 3$ when $n \geq 2k - 3$ [SW20, Theorem 1.3]. They observed that the answer depends on the field and that characteristic two behaves differently. Menezes [Men26] determined the least degree over every field when $k \geq 2$ and $n \geq k - 1$, also prescribing the order of vanishing at the origin.

This paper determines the binary case in every dimension. Throughout, multiplicity means Hasse multiplicity of formal polynomials (Definition 2.1); in particular no polynomial is reduced modulo $x_i^2 - x_i$.

Definition 1.1. Let $n \geq 1$ and $k \geq 1$. For $0 \leq \ell < k$, let $\delta(n, k, \ell)$ be the least total degree of a polynomial $P \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ with $\text{mult}_a(P) \geq k$ for every $a \in \mathbb{F}_2^n \setminus \{\mathbf{0}\}$ and $\text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(P) = \ell$ (such polynomials exist by Theorem 3.8); we call $\text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(P)$ the *origin order* of P . A polynomial is *k-admissible* if $\text{mult}_a(P) \geq k$ for every nonzero a and $\text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(P) \leq k - 1$, and $D(n, k)$ is the least total degree of a *k-admissible* polynomial. Thus $D(n, k) = \min_{0 \leq \ell < k} \delta(n, k, \ell)$ [Lean].

The condition at the origin excludes $P = 0$ and allows any origin order below k , not only a nonzero value at the origin. Returning to a question of Sauermann and Wigderson, this time over $\mathbb{F}_2$, Bishnoi, Boyadzhyska, Das and Mészáros [BBDM23, Question 4.3] asked whether $D(n, k) \geq 2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$ when $k \geq 2^{n-2}$. This bound holds for all n and k , as a direct application of the multiplicity Schwartz–Zippel lemma of Dvir, Kopparty, Saraf and Sudan [DKSS13] (Proposition A.2, the content of an earlier note [Note]). Bishnoi et al. also construct multisets of $2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$ affine hyperplanes that cover every nonzero point at least k times and the origin at most $k - 1$ times, for $k \geq 2^{n-2}$ [BBDM23, Theorem 1.2(a)], so the bound is attained there. What was open is the range $k < 2^{n-2}$: Corollary 1.3 shows that the bound is not attained there and gives the true value.

1.1 Main results

For integers $n \geq 1$ and $0 \leq \ell < k$ put

$$\Phi(n, k, \ell) = n + 2\ell + \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \left\lfloor \frac{k - \ell - 1}{2^j} \right\rfloor.$$

Theorem 1.2. For all integers $n \geq 1$ and $0 \leq \ell < k$, $\delta(n, k, \ell) = \Phi(n, k, \ell)$: some polynomial with multiplicity at least k at every nonzero point of $\mathbb{F}_2^n$ and exactly ℓ at the origin has degree $\Phi(n, k, \ell)$, and every such polynomial has degree at least $\Phi(n, k, \ell)$ [Lean].

Write $k - \ell - 1 = q2^n + r$ with $0 \leq r < 2^n$, and let s_2 be the binary digit sum. By Legendre’s formula (Lemma 3.2),

$$\Phi(n, k, \ell) = n + 2k - 2 - 2q - s_2(r).$$

In particular $\Phi(n, k, \ell) = n + 2k - 2 - s_2(k - \ell - 1)$ when $k - \ell - 1 < 2^n$. When $k - \ell - 1 \geq 2^n$, that is $q \geq 1$, Φ is strictly smaller, since $s_2(k - \ell - 1) = s_2(q) + s_2(r) \leq q + s_2(r) < 2q + s_2(r)$. A polynomial of degree Φ is $y_1^\ell F^{2q} g_{r+1}$, where $y_1 = x_1^2 + x_1$, F is the product of the $2^n - 1$ affine forms $1 + u \cdot x$ with $u \neq \mathbf{0}$, and g_{r+1} is a truncated product (Theorem 3.8); its degree is exactly Φ . The simplest example with $k - \ell - 1 \geq 2^n$ is $n = 1$, $k = 3$, $\ell = 0$: there $\delta = \Phi = 3$, attained by $(1 + x)^3$, while $n + 2k - 2 - s_2(k - \ell - 1) = 4$. The same example appears in Menezes’ discussion of dimensions below his range [Men26, Section 8]. For $n = 2$, $k = 5$, $\ell = 0$ the two values are 8 and 9.

Minimizing over ℓ gives $D(n, k)$.

Corollary 1.3. For all integers $n \geq 1$ and $k \geq 1$,

$$D(n, k) = \min_{0 \leq \ell < k} \Phi(n, k, \ell) = \begin{cases} 2k + n - 2 - \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor, & k < 2^{n-1}, \\ 2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor, & k \geq 2^{n-1}, \end{cases}$$

and some *k-admissible* polynomial has degree exactly $2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$ if and only if $k \geq 2^{n-2}$ [Lean: minimum over ℓ] [Lean: value and attainment].

Both results hold verbatim over every field of characteristic two, and more generally over every commutative ring of characteristic two (Theorem 5.5).

Three features of these formulas stand out.

- **Blocks of 2^n .** As a function of $k - \ell$, the excess $\Phi - n - 2\ell$ grows by $2^{n+1} - 2$ with each block of 2^n . The product F^2 has degree at most $2^{n+1} - 2$ and multiplicity at least 2^n at every nonzero point (Lemma 3.7), and the construction pays each block with one factor F^2 and the remainder r with the truncated product g_{r+1} .
- **Where the Schwartz–Zippel bound is exact.** It is attained if and only if $k \geq 2^{n-2}$. For $k < 2^{n-2}$, $D(n, k)$ exceeds it by $n - 2 - \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor \geq 1$. In the range $n \geq \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor + 2$ of the logarithmic formula, each further dimension costs exactly one degree; for example $D(n, 1) = n$, $D(n, 4) = n + 4$, $D(n, 8) = n + 11$ and $D(n, 15) = n + 25$ there.
- **Comparison with the reals.** Over $\mathbb{R}$, for $k \geq 2$, the least degree with origin order $\ell \leq k - 2$ is $n + 2k - 3$ when $n \geq 2k - 3$ [SW20, Theorem 1.4], a range that Huang, Wang and Wang extend to $n \geq k - 1$ [HWW26, Theorem 1.8], and the least degree with origin order $k - 1$ is $n + 2k - 2$ for every $n \geq 1$ [SW20, Theorem 1.5]. For $n \geq k - 1$ we have $k - \ell - 1 < 2^n$, so over $\mathbb{F}_2$ the value is $n + 2k - 2 - s_2(k - \ell - 1)$. For $\ell \leq k - 2$ this is at most the real value $n + 2k - 3$, and strictly lower unless $k - \ell - 1$ is a power of two; for $\ell = k - 1$ it is $n + 2k - 2$, as over the reals.

1.2 Relation to previous work

- **Menezes [Men26].** In a recent preprint, Menezes determines, over every field $\mathbb{F}$, the least degree $\delta_{\mathbb{F}}(n, k, \ell)$ of a polynomial with order at least k at the nonzero vertices of $\{0, 1\}^n$ and order exactly ℓ at the origin, for $k \geq 2$ and $n \geq k - 1$. In characteristic two his formula is $n + 2k - 2 - s_2(k - \ell - 1)$ [Men26, Corollary 1.3]. For $n \geq k - 1$ we have $k - \ell - 1 < 2^n$, so Theorem 1.2 agrees with it there. He notes that the hypothesis $n \geq k - 1$ is substantive, gives $\delta_{\mathbb{F}}(1, k, \ell) = k + \ell$ over every field, and names smaller dimensions as a further direction, where a formula must account for cancellation between his basis elements [Men26, Section 8]. For $n = 1$ our formula also gives $k + \ell$. So the new range is $2 \leq n < k - 1$, over every field of characteristic two (Theorem 5.5), where the formula changes form as soon as $k - \ell - 1 \geq 2^n$. Our upper-bound construction multiplies Menezes' Catalan truncation, specialized to $\mathbb{F}_2$ (Lemma 3.5), by powers of F . Menezes proves that his truncation vanishes to the required order in every dimension [Men26, Theorem 3.2] and determines the degree of each of his basis elements, which include $y_1^\ell \hat{g}_{k-\ell}$ for $\ell \leq k - 2$, for all n [Men26, Section 8]; only his exact formula for the minimum needs $n \geq k - 1$. Over $\mathbb{F}_2$ the telescoping identity of Lemma 3.3 gives a short alternative proof of the vanishing. Our lower bound is proved independently of [Men26].
- **Bishnoi, Boyadzhyska, Das and Mészáros [BBDM23].** They determine the least size of a multiset of affine hyperplanes (and, more generally, subspaces of codimension d) covering the nonzero points of $\mathbb{F}_2^n$ at least k times and the origin at most $k - 1$ times, for $k \geq 2^{n-2}$. With Proposition A.2, which answers their question on the polynomial version, they determine $D(n, k)$ for $k \geq 2^{n-2}$. Corollary 1.3 completes the range $k < 2^{n-2}$, and Theorem 1.2 refines every value by the origin order. They refine their covers in the same way, by the number of times the origin is covered [BBDM23, Section 2]. The factor F is the product of the affine forms of the $2^n - 1$ hyperplanes of their covers that avoid the origin.

- **Sauermann and Wigderson [SW20]**. Their theorems are the real case described above. Their Theorem 1.5, the case $\ell = k - 1$ with value $n + 2k - 2$ for every $n \geq 1$, is stated over $\mathbb{R}$, and Bishnoi et al. note that its proof is valid over every field [BBDM23, Section 1.3]. So the case $\ell = k - 1$ of Theorem 1.2, where $\Phi(n, k, k - 1) = n + 2k - 2$, is not new. In characteristic two they give a polynomial of degree $n + 4$ for $k = 4$, below $n + 2k - 3 = n + 5$, showing that the real formula fails there.
- **Dvir, Kopparty, Saraf and Sudan [DKSS13]**. Their multiplicity Schwartz–Zippel lemma is used only in the second proof of Corollary 1.3 (Appendix A) and for Proposition A.2.
- **Alon [Alo99] and Alon and Füredi [AF93]**. The lower bound of Theorem 1.2 reduces to the grid-vanishing lemma of the combinatorial Nullstellensatz [Alo99, Lemma 2.1], applied to a grid V^h whose base $V \subset \mathbb{F}_2[y_1, \dots, y_n]$ is the $\mathbb{F}_2$ -span of $y_1, \dots, y_n$, of size 2^n . For $k = 1$ and $n \geq 2$, where $k < 2^{n-1}$, Corollary 1.3 gives $D(n, 1) = n$; the lower bound is the case $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{F}_2$ of [AF93, Theorem 5].

A search on 25 September 2026 of the works citing [SW20], [BBDM23] and [Men26] found no determination of δ over $\mathbb{F}_2$ for $2 \leq n < k - 1$; a bounded search does not establish that none exists.

1.3 Notation

Throughout, n is the number of variables, k the multiplicity required at nonzero points and $\ell < k$ the origin order. We write $m = k - \ell - 1 = q2^n + r$ with $0 \leq r < 2^n$, and $h = 2q + s_2(r)$, so that $\Phi = n + 2k - 2 - h$ (Lemma 3.2). Further, $y_i = x_i^2 + x_i$ (in Section 4, y_i is an independent variable, and substituting $y_i \mapsto x_i^2 + x_i$ recovers this meaning); $F = \prod_{u \neq \mathbf{0}} (1 + u \cdot x)$ is the hyperplane product (Section 3); g_s is the truncated product (Definition 3.4); $\hat{x}_K(Y) = \sum_{j < K} Y^{2^j}$ is the truncated local inverse of $x \mapsto x^2 + x$, and $w = P(\hat{x}_K(y_1), \dots, \hat{x}_K(y_n))$ (Section 4). For a polynomial f , f_d is its homogeneous component of degree d .

1.4 Proof outline

- **Upper bound (Section 3)**. With $y = x^2 + x$ we have $(1 + x) + \sum_{j < K} y^{2^j} = (1 + x)^{2^K}$ over $\mathbb{F}_2$. Expanding $\prod_i (1 + x_i)^{2^K}$ this way and discarding the terms of cost at least s leaves a polynomial g_s . It still vanishes to order s off the origin, takes the value 1 at the origin, and has small degree (Theorem 3.6). The product F has multiplicity at least 2^{n-1} at every nonzero point. Multiplying $F^{2^q} g_{r+1}$ by y_1^ℓ sets the origin order (Theorem 3.8).
- **Lower bound (Section 4)**. Write $P = \sum_\varepsilon x^\varepsilon A_\varepsilon(x^2 + x)$ with squarefree x^ε . A nonzero coefficient of y^ε in A_ε forces $\deg P \geq |\varepsilon| + 2|e|$. The multiplicity conditions determine the low-degree parts of every A_ε from one polynomial w , the composition of P with the truncated additive local inverse $\hat{x}_K(y) = \sum_{j < K} y^{2^j}$ of $x^2 + x$. So a polynomial of degree below Φ makes certain parts of $w \prod_{i \in T} \hat{x}_K(y_i)$ vanish. These parts are values of additive forms, and a recursion for repeated arguments shows that the forms vanish on the whole span V of $y_1, \dots, y_n$. Reducing modulo $\prod_{v \in V} (Y - v)$ and applying the grid-vanishing lemma then isolates the lowest part w_ℓ , which is nonzero.
- **Second proof of Corollary 1.3 (Appendix A)**. After an invertible linear change of coordinates $Q = P \circ A$, the polynomial $S = Q(0, x') + Q(1, x')$ has multiplicity at least k at the nonzero points of $\mathbb{F}_2^{n-1}$, the same origin order as P , and degree at least one lower

(Theorem A.6). Iterating down to $n_0 = \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor + 2$, where the multiplicity Schwartz–Zippel lemma already gives degree $2k$, yields $D(n, k) \geq 2k + n - n_0$.

1.5 Formal verification

Every theorem, lemma, proposition and corollary of this paper is proved in Lean 4 with Mathlib, including the multiplicity Schwartz–Zippel lemma, the hyperplane covers and the parity of Catalan numbers, and so are the arithmetic facts used in the remarks, examples and comparisons. The proofs use only Lean’s standard axioms. Each numbered statement carries a [Lean] link to its formal proof at a fixed repository commit, except the grid-vanishing lemma (Lemma 4.6), which the Lean proof takes from Mathlib; Appendix B maps every statement, including the facts in the prose, to its declarations and gives the commands to check them. Not formalized are statements about the content of other papers, which we cite rather than prove. Formal verification covers the statements under the linked definitions, not the prose or the fidelity of the definitions to the informal notions, although the definitions are short (Definitions 2.1 and 1.1).

2 Multiplicity

Let $\mathbb{F}$ be a field and σ a finite set of variables. Degrees are total degrees of formal polynomials in $\mathbb{F}[x_\sigma]$. For a multi-index $\beta \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}^\sigma$ write $|\beta| = \sum_i \beta_i$.

Definition 2.1 (Hasse multiplicity). For $P \in \mathbb{F}[x_\sigma]$ and $a \in \mathbb{F}^\sigma$, write $P(a + z) = \sum_\beta c_\beta z^\beta$. The *multiplicity* of P at a is

$$\text{mult}_a(P) = \min\{|\beta| : c_\beta \neq 0\} \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0} \cup \{\infty\},$$

with $\text{mult}_a(0) = \infty$ [Lean].

Dvir, Kopparty, Saraf and Sudan call the coefficient c_β the Hasse derivative $P^{(\beta)}(a)$, and this is their definition [DKSS13, Definition 2.2]. In Lean, $\text{mult}_a(P)$ is the order, in $\mathbb{N}_\infty$, of the power series of the shifted polynomial $P(a + z)$.

Lemma 2.2. *Let $P, Q \in \mathbb{F}[x_\sigma]$ and $a \in \mathbb{F}^\sigma$.*

1. *For $m \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, $\text{mult}_a(P) \geq m$ if and only if every coefficient of $P(a + z)$ of degree less than m vanishes.*
2. $\text{mult}_a(P + Q) \geq \min(\text{mult}_a(P), \text{mult}_a(Q))$.
3. $\text{mult}_a(PQ) = \text{mult}_a(P) + \text{mult}_a(Q)$. *(The inequality $\geq$ holds over every commutative ring, equality over every integral domain.)*
4. $\text{mult}_a(P) = 0$ if and only if $P(a) \neq 0$.
5. *If $e : \sigma \rightarrow \tau$ is a bijection and $P^e \in \mathbb{F}[x_\tau]$ is obtained by renaming x_i to $x_{e(i)}$, then $\text{mult}_b(P^e) = \text{mult}_{b \circ e}(P)$ for all $b \in \mathbb{F}^\tau$.*

[Lean]

Proof. Part 1 is the definition. Part 2 holds because a coefficient of the sum of degree below both minima is a sum of two zero coefficients. For part 3, the lowest homogeneous parts of $P(a+z)$ and $Q(a+z)$ multiply to the part of degree $\text{mult}_a(P) + \text{mult}_a(Q)$ of $(PQ)(a+z)$; over a field this product is nonzero when both factors are. Part 4 holds because the constant coefficient of $P(a+z)$ is $P(a)$. For part 5, renaming commutes with the shift, and it maps the monomials of degree d bijectively to the monomials of degree d . $\square$

For f in a polynomial ring over $\mathbb{F}$, write f_d for its homogeneous component of degree d , and $\text{ord } f = \text{mult}_0(f)$ for the least d with $f_d \neq 0$.

Lemma 2.3 (Substitution). *Let $P \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$, $a \in \mathbb{F}_2^\sigma$, and let ζ_i ($i \in \sigma$) be polynomials over $\mathbb{F}_2$ without constant term. Then $\text{mult}_a(P) \leq \text{ord } P(a + \zeta)$ [Lean].*

Proof. Write $P(a+z) = \sum_\beta c_\beta z^\beta$, so that $P(a+\zeta) = \sum_\beta c_\beta \zeta^\beta$. Substituting elements of order at least one does not lower the order: ζ^β is a product of $|\beta|$ such elements. Every β with $c_\beta \neq 0$ has $|\beta| \geq \text{mult}_a(P)$. $\square$

3 The upper bound

From now on the field is $\mathbb{F}_2$ unless stated otherwise.

3.1 Binary digit sums

Let $s_2(m)$ be the sum of the binary digits of $m \geq 0$.

Lemma 3.1. *For all $a, b, j, J \geq 0$:*

1. $s_2(a+b) \leq s_2(a) + s_2(b)$ and $s_2(2^j) = 1$. Hence a sum of r powers of two has digit sum at most r .
2. $s_2(a) \leq a$.
3. If $a \leq b$, then $2a + s_2(b) \leq 2b + s_2(a)$. That is, $a \mapsto 2a - s_2(a)$ is monotone.
4. $s_2(2^J - 1) = J$.

[Lean: parts 1–3] [Lean: part 4]

Proof. All four parts use the recursion $s_2(m) = (m \bmod 2) + s_2(\lfloor m/2 \rfloor)$.

1. The first inequality is proved by strong induction on $a+b$, using $\lfloor (a+b)/2 \rfloor = \lfloor a/2 \rfloor + \lfloor b/2 \rfloor + c$, where $c = \lfloor ((a \bmod 2) + (b \bmod 2))/2 \rfloor$ is the carry. The value $s_2(2^j) = 1$ follows from the recursion by induction on j .
2. This is standard; Mathlib proves it for every base.
3. Induct on $b-a$, using $s_2(b+1) \leq s_2(b) + 1$, which is part 1 with second summand 1.
4. $2^{J+1} - 1$ is odd with $\lfloor (2^{J+1} - 1)/2 \rfloor = 2^J - 1$. $\square$

Lemma 3.2 (Legendre form). *Let $n \geq 0$, $q \geq 0$ and $0 \leq r < 2^n$, and put $m = q2^n + r$. Then*

$$\sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \left\lfloor \frac{m}{2^j} \right\rfloor + 2q + s_2(r) = 2m.$$

Hence, for $n \geq 1$, $0 \leq \ell < k$ and $k - \ell - 1 = q2^n + r$ with $0 \leq r < 2^n$, $\Phi(n, k, \ell) = n + 2k - 2 - 2q - s_2(r)$, and $\Phi(n, k, \ell) = n + 2k - 2 - s_2(k - \ell - 1)$ when $k - \ell - 1 < 2^n$. Moreover m is the sum of $h = 2q + s_2(r)$ powers of two, each at most 2^{n-1} when $n \geq 1$: $2q$ copies of 2^{n-1} and the binary digits of r [Lean] [Lean: form of Φ].

Proof. For $j < n$, $\lfloor m/2^j \rfloor = q2^{n-j} + \lfloor r/2^j \rfloor$, and $\sum_{j < n} q2^{n-j} = 2q2^n - 2q$. Since $r < 2^n$, $\sum_{j < n} \lfloor r/2^j \rfloor = \sum_{j \geq 0} \lfloor r/2^j \rfloor$, which is $2r - s_2(r)$. This is Legendre's classical identity $\sum_{j \geq 1} \lfloor r/2^j \rfloor = r - s_2(r)$, plus the term $j = 0$; by induction, for $r = 2r' + b$ with $b \in \{0, 1\}$ the sum is $r + (2r' - s_2(r')) = 2r - s_2(r)$. Adding gives $2m - 2q - s_2(r)$. The formula for Φ follows with $m = k - \ell - 1$, since $n + 2\ell + 2m = n + 2k - 2$. For the decomposition, $2q \cdot 2^{n-1} = q2^n$, and the binary digits of $r < 2^n$ are powers 2^j with $j \leq n - 1$. $\square$

3.2 The truncated product

Put $y_i = x_i^2 + x_i = x_i(1 + x_i)$.

Lemma 3.3. *In every commutative ring of characteristic two and for every t and $K \geq 0$, $\sum_{j < K} (t^2 + t)^{2^j} = t^{2^K} + t$. In particular, over $\mathbb{F}_2$,*

$$(1 + x) + \sum_{j < K} y^{2^j} = (1 + x)^{2^K}, \quad y = x^2 + x$$

[Lean].

Proof. By Frobenius, $(t^2 + t)^{2^j} = t^{2^{j+1}} + t^{2^j}$, so the sum telescopes. For the second form take $t = 1 + x$, for which $t^2 + t = x^2 + x$. $\square$

Definition 3.4 (Truncated product). For $s \geq 1$, let $g_s \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$ be the sum, over all subsets $S \subseteq \sigma$ and all assignments $i \mapsto p_i$ of powers of two to $i \in S$ with $\sum_{i \in S} p_i \leq s - 1$, of

$$\prod_{i \in S} y_i^{p_i} \prod_{i \notin S} (1 + x_i)$$

[Lean].

Lemma 3.5 (Catalan parity [AK73], [DS06, Theorem 2.1]). *For $a \geq 1$, $v_2(C_{a-1}) = s_2(a) - 1$. In particular the Catalan number C_{a-1} is odd if and only if a is a power of two [Lean].*

Proof. By Kummer's theorem, $v_2\binom{2n}{n}$ is the number of carries when adding n to itself in base two, which is $s_2(n)$. Since $(n+1)C_n = \binom{2n}{n}$, $v_2(C_n) = s_2(n) - v_2(n+1) = s_2(n+1) - 1$, where the last step is $s_2(n+1) + v_2(n+1) = s_2(n) + 1$: adding one clears the $v_2(n+1)$ trailing ones of n and sets one bit. Take $n = a - 1$. $\square$

For $s \geq 2$, Menezes' Catalan truncation [Men26, equation (12)] is the integral polynomial

$$\hat{g}_s = (-1)^{s-1} \sum_{S, (a_i)} (-1)^{\sum_{i \in S} a_i} \prod_{i \in S} C_{a_i-1} (x_i(x_i - 1))^{a_i} \prod_{j \notin S} (x_j - 1),$$

summed over $S \subseteq \sigma$ and integers $a_i \geq 1$ ($i \in S$) with $\sum_{i \in S} a_i \leq s - 1$. Modulo two the signs disappear, $x(x - 1)$ becomes $y = x^2 + x$, $x_j - 1$ becomes $1 + x_j$, and by Lemma 3.5 a term survives exactly when every a_i is a power of two. So $\widehat{g}_s$ reduces to g_s .

Theorem 3.6. *For every finite σ with $|\sigma| = n$ and every $s \geq 1$:*

1. $\text{mult}_a(g_s) \geq s$ for every nonzero $a \in \mathbb{F}_2^\sigma$;
2. $g_s(\mathbf{0}) = 1$;
3. $\deg g_s \leq n + 2(s - 1) - s_2(s - 1)$.

[Lean]

Proof. Expansion. By Lemma 3.3 with $K = s$,

$$\prod_{i \in \sigma} (1 + x_i)^{2^s} = \prod_{i \in \sigma} \left((1 + x_i) + \sum_{j < s} y_i^{2^j} \right).$$

Expanding the right-hand side gives the terms of Definition 3.4 of every cost. Hence the left-hand side equals $g_s + R$, where R collects the terms of cost at least s . This includes every term that uses a power $2^j > s - 1$.

Multiplicity (1).

- Since $u^2 + u = 0$ on $\mathbb{F}_2$, each y_i vanishes at every point of $\mathbb{F}_2^\sigma$. Lemma 2.2(3) then gives each term of R multiplicity at least its cost, so at least s everywhere. By Lemma 2.2(2), so does R .
- At a nonzero a , choose i_0 with $a_{i_0} = 1$. Then $(1 + x_{i_0})^{2^s}$ has multiplicity at least $2^s \geq s$ at a , and so does the whole product.

In characteristic two, g_s equals the product plus R , so $\text{mult}_a(g_s) \geq s$.

Value (2). Every term with $S \neq \emptyset$ vanishes at $\mathbf{0}$, and the term with $S = \emptyset$ is $\prod (1 + 0) = 1$.

Degree (3). The term of (S, p) has degree at most $(n - |S|) + 2\mu$, where $\mu = \sum_{i \in S} p_i \leq s - 1$. By Lemma 3.1(1), $|S| \geq s_2(\mu)$. By Lemma 3.1(3), $2\mu - s_2(\mu) \leq 2(s - 1) - s_2(s - 1)$. $\square$

3.3 The hyperplane product

Let $F = \prod_{u \in \mathbb{F}_2^n \setminus \{\mathbf{0}\}} (1 + u \cdot x)$, where $u \cdot x = \sum_i u_i x_i$. Its $2^n - 1$ factors define the hyperplanes $u \cdot x = 1$, which avoid the origin.

Lemma 3.7. *For $n \geq 1$: $\text{mult}_a(F) \geq 2^{n-1}$ for every nonzero $a \in \mathbb{F}_2^n$, $F(\mathbf{0}) = 1$, and $\deg F \leq 2^n - 1$* [Lean].

Proof. Fix $a \neq \mathbf{0}$ and i with $a_i = 1$. Flipping u_i is an involution of $\mathbb{F}_2^n$ that changes $u \cdot a$ by one, so exactly 2^{n-1} vectors u satisfy $u \cdot a = 1$. All of them are nonzero, so they index factors of F that vanish at a . Lemma 2.2(3,4) gives the first claim. Each factor takes the value 1 at $\mathbf{0}$ and has degree at most one. $\square$

These are the facts behind the hyperplane covers of [BBDM23] (Remark A.9).

3.4 The construction

Theorem 3.8. *Let σ be finite with $|\sigma| = n \geq 1$, fix $x_1 \in \sigma$, let $0 \leq \ell < k$, and write $k - \ell - 1 = q2^n + r$ with $0 \leq r < 2^n$. The polynomial*

$$P = y_1^\ell F^{2q} g_{r+1}$$

satisfies:

1. $\text{mult}_a(P) \geq k$ for every nonzero a ;
2. $\text{mult}_0(P) = \ell$;
3. $\deg P \leq \Phi(n, k, \ell)$.

Hence $\delta(n, k, \ell) \leq \Phi(n, k, \ell)$ [Lean].

Proof. 1. Since $u^2 + u = 0$ on $\mathbb{F}_2$, y_1 vanishes at every point, so $\text{mult}_a(y_1^\ell) \geq \ell$. With Lemma 3.7, Theorem 3.6(1) and Lemma 2.2(3), at $a \neq 0$ we get $\text{mult}_a(P) \geq \ell + 2q \cdot 2^{n-1} + (r+1) = \ell + (k - \ell - 1) + 1 = k$.

2. y_1 has origin order exactly one: its coefficient of x_1 is 1. Also $F(0) = g_{r+1}(0) = 1$, so these factors have origin order zero. Multiplicities add over $\mathbb{F}_2$ (Lemma 2.2(3)).

3. $\deg y_1^\ell \leq 2\ell$, $\deg F^{2q} \leq 2q(2^n - 1)$, and $\deg g_{r+1} \leq n + 2r - s_2(r)$ by Theorem 3.6(3). The sum is $n + 2\ell + 2(q2^n + r) - 2q - s_2(r) = n + 2k - 2 - 2q - s_2(r)$, which is $\Phi(n, k, \ell)$ by Lemma 3.2. $\square$

For $k - \ell - 1 < 2^n$ we have $q = 0$, and $P = y_1^\ell g_{k-\ell}$ is Menezes' polynomial over $\mathbb{F}_2$. Proposition 3.9 is his result specialized to $\mathbb{F}_2$, which holds in every dimension [Men26, Theorem 3.2 and Section 8]; the proof below uses the telescoping identity instead. When $k - \ell - 1 \geq 2^n$ its degree bound exceeds $\Phi(n, k, \ell)$.

Proposition 3.9. *Let $|\sigma| = n \geq 1$, $x_1 \in \sigma$ and $0 \leq \ell < k$. Then $P = y_1^\ell g_{k-\ell}$ has $\text{mult}_a(P) \geq k$ for every nonzero a , $\text{mult}_0(P) = \ell$, and $\deg P \leq n + 2k - 2 - s_2(k - \ell - 1)$ [Lean].*

Proof. As in the proof of Theorem 3.8, with $g_{k-\ell}$ in place of $F^{2q}g_{r+1}$: the multiplicity off the origin is at least $\ell + (k - \ell)$, the origin order is ℓ , and the degree is at most $2\ell + n + 2(k - \ell - 1) - s_2(k - \ell - 1)$ by Theorem 3.6(3). $\square$

Menezes proves the degree $n + 2k - 2 - s_2(k - \ell - 1)$ optimal when $n \geq k - 1$ [Men26, Corollary 1.3]. Section 4 proves Theorem 3.8 optimal in every dimension; the construction has degree exactly $\Phi(n, k, \ell)$.

4 The lower bound at every origin order

Throughout this section σ is finite with $|\sigma| = n \geq 1$. Besides $\mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$ we use a second polynomial ring $\mathbb{F}_2[y_\sigma]$ in independent variables y_i . For $A \in \mathbb{F}_2[y_\sigma]$, $A(x^2 + x)$ denotes the substitution $y_i \mapsto x_i^2 + x_i$. For $\varepsilon \subseteq \sigma$ put $x^\varepsilon = \prod_{i \in \varepsilon} x_i$, and for an exponent vector e put $|e| = \sum_i e_i$. Recall that f_d is the homogeneous component of degree d of f , and put $f_d = 0$ for $d < 0$. For $K \geq 0$ let

$$\hat{x}_K(Y) = \sum_{j < K} Y^{2^j}.$$

Lemma 4.1 (The local inverse). *Over $\mathbb{F}_2$, $\hat{x}_K(Y)^2 + \hat{x}_K(Y) = Y + Y^{2^K}$. The series $\hat{x}(Y) = \sum_{j \geq 0} Y^{2^j}$ satisfies $\hat{x}^2 + \hat{x} = Y$ in $\mathbb{F}_2[[Y]]$, and $\hat{x}_K$ is its truncation below degree 2^K [Lean: $\hat{x}_K$] [Lean: series].*

Proof. By Frobenius, $\hat{x}_K^2 + \hat{x}_K = \sum_{j < K} (Y^{2^{j+1}} + Y^{2^j})$, which telescopes to $Y + Y^{2^K}$. The coefficients of $\hat{x}$ and $\hat{x}_K$ agree below degree 2^K , so the coefficients of $\hat{x}^2 + \hat{x}$ and $\hat{x}_K^2 + \hat{x}_K$ agree below degree 2^K ; letting K grow gives $\hat{x}^2 + \hat{x} = Y$. $\square$

So $\hat{x}_K(y)$ inverts $x \mapsto x^2 + x$ up to order 2^K : it is the truncation of the additive root of the Artin–Schreier equation $X^2 + X = Y$.

Plan. Suppose $\deg P < \Phi$. Lemmas 4.2 and 4.3 turn the degree bound and the multiplicities into the vanishing of certain homogeneous parts of $w \prod_{i \in T} \hat{x}_K(y_i)$, and Lemma 4.4 shows that w starts in degree exactly ℓ . These parts are values, at the generators y_i , of additive forms (Lemma 4.5), and a recursion carries the vanishing from tuples of distinct generators to all tuples, hence to the span V . Vanishing on V is a statement about values, not coefficients. The reduction modulo $\prod_{v \in V} (Y - v)$ (Lemma 4.7) turns it into a statement about coefficients, and one coefficient is w_ℓ .

4.1 The expansion

Lemma 4.2 (Expansion). *Every $P \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$ can be written as*

$$P = \sum_{\varepsilon \subseteq \sigma} x^\varepsilon A_\varepsilon(x^2 + x), \quad A_\varepsilon \in \mathbb{F}_2[y_\sigma].$$

For every such expansion, if the monomial y^e occurs in A_ε , then $|\varepsilon| + 2|e| \leq \deg P$ [Lean].

Proof. For existence it suffices to expand a monomial, and by multiplicativity a power x_i^b . By induction on b , x_i^b is a sum of terms $x_i^\eta y_i^c$ with $\eta \in \{0, 1\}$: this holds for $b \leq 1$, and $x_i^b = x_i^{b-2}(x_i^2 + x_i) + x_i^{b-1}$.

For the degree bound, let W be the largest value of $|\varepsilon| + 2|e|$ over the pairs (ε, e) with y^e in A_ε , with coefficient $c_{\varepsilon, e}$. The polynomial $x^\varepsilon(x^2 + x)^e$ has degree $|\varepsilon| + 2|e|$, and its homogeneous component of that degree is the single monomial $x^{1_\varepsilon + 2e}$. The map $(\varepsilon, e) \mapsto 1_\varepsilon + 2e$ is injective, since ε is the set of odd coordinates. So the component of degree W of P is $\sum c_{\varepsilon, e} x^{1_\varepsilon + 2e}$ over the pairs of weight W , a sum of distinct monomials, which is nonzero. Hence $\deg P \geq W$. $\square$

4.2 The multiplicity conditions

Lemma 4.3 (Congruence). *Let $k \geq 1$ and K with $2^K \geq k$. Let $P \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$ have $\text{mult}_a(P) \geq k$ for every nonzero $a \in \mathbb{F}_2^\sigma$, and let $P = \sum_\varepsilon x^\varepsilon A_\varepsilon(x^2 + x)$ be any expansion. Put $\hat{x}_i = \hat{x}_K(y_i)$ and $w = P(\hat{x}) \in \mathbb{F}_2[y_\sigma]$. Then for every $\varepsilon \subseteq \sigma$ and every $d < k$,*

$$(A_\varepsilon)_d = \left(w \prod_{i \notin \varepsilon} (1 + \hat{x}_i) \right)_d$$

[Lean].

Proof. Write $\equiv$ for equality of all homogeneous components of degree below k .

- *The substitution.* For $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_2^\sigma$ substitute $x_i \mapsto \hat{x}_i + \gamma_i$. Since $\gamma_i^2 = \gamma_i$ and the cross term vanishes in characteristic two, $x_i^2 + x_i$ goes to $\hat{x}_i^2 + \hat{x}_i = y_i + y_i^{2^K} =: \hat{y}_i$ for both values of γ_i (Lemma 4.1). Hence

$$P(\hat{x} + \gamma) = \sum_{\varepsilon'} \prod_{i \in \varepsilon'} (\hat{x}_i + \gamma_i) A_{\varepsilon'}(\hat{y}).$$

- *Nonzero shifts.* The $\hat{x}_i$ have no constant term, so for $\gamma \neq \mathbf{0}$ Lemma 2.3 and $\text{mult}_\gamma(P) \geq k$ give $\text{ord } P(\gamma + \hat{x}) \geq k$, that is, $P(\hat{x} + \gamma) \equiv 0$.
- *Inversion.* For $c \in \mathbb{F}_2$ put $N_i(c) = 1$ if $i \in \varepsilon$, and otherwise $N_i(0) = 1 + \hat{x}_i$, $N_i(1) = \hat{x}_i$. A check of the four cases gives

$$\sum_{c \in \mathbb{F}_2} N_i(c) (\hat{x}_i + c)^{[i \in \varepsilon']} = [i \in \varepsilon \Leftrightarrow i \in \varepsilon'].$$

For instance, for $i \notin \varepsilon$ and $i \in \varepsilon'$ the sum is $(1 + \hat{x}_i)\hat{x}_i + \hat{x}_i(\hat{x}_i + 1) = 0$. Multiplying over i and summing over $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_2^\sigma$ gives $\sum_\gamma \prod_i N_i(\gamma_i) \prod_{i \in \varepsilon'} (\hat{x}_i + \gamma_i) = [\varepsilon' = \varepsilon]$, and therefore

$$A_\varepsilon(\hat{y}) = \sum_\gamma \prod_i N_i(\gamma_i) P(\hat{x} + \gamma).$$

- *Conclusion.* Modulo $\equiv$ only $\gamma = \mathbf{0}$ survives, and it contributes $\prod_{i \notin \varepsilon} (1 + \hat{x}_i) w$. Finally $\hat{y}_i - y_i = y_i^{2^K}$ has order $2^K \geq k$, so $A_\varepsilon(\hat{y}) \equiv A_\varepsilon(y)$. $\square$

Lemma 4.4 (The lowest part). *Let $0 \leq \ell < k$ and $P \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$ with $\text{mult}_0(P) = \ell$, and put $w = P(\hat{x}_k(y_1), \dots, \hat{x}_k(y_n))$. Then $w_d = 0$ for $d < \ell$ and $w_\ell \neq 0$ [Lean].*

No condition at the nonzero points is needed here. In the proof, $K = k$, so $2^K \geq k$.

Proof. Since the $\hat{x}_i$ have no constant term, $\text{ord } w \geq \ell$ (Lemma 2.3). Substitute $y_i \mapsto x_i^2 + x_i$ in w . By Lemma 3.3 with $t = x_i$, $\hat{x}_K(x_i^2 + x_i) = x_i + x_i^{2^K}$, so the result is $P(x + x^{2^K})$. The difference $P(x + x^{2^K}) - P(x)$ lies in the ideal generated by the $x_i^{2^K}$, so it has order at least $2^K \geq k > \ell$, and $P(x + x^{2^K})$ has order exactly ℓ . If w_ℓ were zero, then $\text{ord } w > \ell$, and since each $x_i^2 + x_i$ has order one, $P(x + x^{2^K})$ would have order above ℓ , by Lemma 2.3. $\square$

4.3 Additive forms

Fix $k \geq 1$ and $w \in \mathbb{F}_2[y_\sigma]$. For $t \geq 0$, $j \geq 0$ and $Y_1, \dots, Y_j \in \mathbb{F}_2[y_\sigma]$ put

$$E_j^{(t)}(Y_1, \dots, Y_j) = \sum_{\tau \in \{0, \dots, k-1\}^j} Y_1^{2^{\tau_1}} \cdots Y_j^{2^{\tau_j}} w_{k-1-t-\sum_a 2^{\tau_a}}.$$

Lemma 4.5 (Forms). *For all $t, j \geq 0$:*

1. $E_j^{(t)}$ is symmetric, and additive in each argument.
2. For $t < k$ and $i_1, \dots, i_j \in \sigma$, $E_j^{(t)}(y_{i_1}, \dots, y_{i_j}) = (w \prod_a \hat{x}_k(y_{i_a}))_{k-1-t}$.
3. For $j \geq 0$ and all $Y, Z_1, \dots, Z_j$,

$$E_{j+2}^{(t)}(Y, Y, Z) = E_{j+1}^{(t)}(Y, Z) + Y E_j^{(t+1)}(Z).$$

[Lean]

Part 2 is stated for $t < k$, the only case used; this also keeps the degree $k - 1 - t$ nonnegative in the Lean statement.

- Proof.* 1. Permuting the arguments permutes the index set. Additivity holds because $Y \mapsto Y^{2^s}$ is additive in characteristic two.
2. Expand $\prod_a \hat{x}_k(y_{i_a}) = \sum_\tau \prod_a y_{i_a}^{2^{\tau_a}}$ over $\tau \in \{0, \dots, k-1\}^j$. Each product is homogeneous of degree $\sum_a 2^{\tau_a}$, so the component of degree $k-1-t$ of w times it is $\prod_a y_{i_a}^{2^{\tau_a}} w_{k-1-t-\sum_a 2^{\tau_a}}$.
3. In $E_{j+2}^{(t)}(Y, Y, Z)$ the terms with $\tau_1 \neq \tau_2$ cancel in pairs under the exchange of τ_1 and τ_2 . The terms with $\tau_1 = \tau_2 = \nu$ give $Y^{2^{\nu+1}} w_{k-1-t-2^{\nu+1}-\Sigma}$, where Σ is the contribution of Z . In $E_{j+1}^{(t)}(Y, Z)$, the terms with Y -exponent $2^{\nu+1}$, $0 \leq \nu < k-1$, are the same terms. The remaining diagonal term $\nu = k-1$ is zero, because $2^k > k-1-t$ makes the index of w negative. The terms of $E_{j+1}^{(t)}(Y, Z)$ with Y -exponent 1 are $Y w_{k-1-(t+1)-\Sigma}$, which sum to $Y E_j^{(t+1)}(Z)$. Signs do not matter in characteristic two. $\square$

4.4 Reduction on a grid

Lemma 4.6 (Grid vanishing [Alo99, Lemma 2.1]). *Let D be an integral domain, $V \subseteq D$ finite, and $R \in D[Y_1, \dots, Y_h]$ of degree less than $|V|$ in each variable. If R vanishes on V^h , then $R = 0$.*

Proof. Induct on h . Write $R = \sum_{e < |V|} R_e(Y_1, \dots, Y_{h-1}) Y_h^e$. For fixed $v' \in V^{h-1}$, the polynomial $R(v', Y_h)$ has degree less than $|V|$ and $|V|$ roots, so it is zero, and $R_e(v') = 0$ for every e . By induction every R_e is zero. $\square$

Mathlib proves this lemma as part of the combinatorial Nullstellensatz, and the Lean proof uses that version.

Lemma 4.7 (Grid reduction). *Let D be an integral domain, $V \subseteq D$ finite, $L_V = \prod_{v \in V} (Y - v)$, and ρ_N the remainder of Y^N modulo L_V . Let I be finite, $c_i \in D$ and $d_{i,a} \geq 0$ for $i \in I$ and $a = 1, \dots, h$. If*

$$\sum_{i \in I} c_i \prod_{a=1}^h v_a^{d_{i,a}} = 0 \quad \text{for all } v \in V^h,$$

then for all exponents $e_1, \dots, e_h < |V|$,

$$\sum_{i \in I} c_i \prod_{a=1}^h [Y^{e_a}] \rho_{d_{i,a}} = 0$$

[Lean].

Proof. If V is empty, the conclusion is vacuous for $h \geq 1$ and is the hypothesis for $h = 0$; so let V be nonempty. Let $R = \sum_i c_i \prod_a \rho_{d_{i,a}}(Y_a)$. It has degree less than $|V|$ in each variable, because $\deg \rho_N < |V|$. Since L_V divides $Y^N - \rho_N$ and vanishes on V , $\rho_N(v) = v^N$ for $v \in V$, so R vanishes on V^h . By Lemma 4.6, $R = 0$. Its coefficient of $\prod_a Y_a^{e_a}$ is the displayed sum. $\square$

4.5 The lower bound

Theorem 4.8. *Let $n \geq 1$ and $0 \leq \ell < k$. Every $P \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$ with $\text{mult}_a(P) \geq k$ for all nonzero a and $\text{mult}_0(P) = \ell$ satisfies $\deg P \geq \Phi(n, k, \ell)$ [Lean].*

Proof. Let $m = k - \ell - 1 = q2^n + r$ with $0 \leq r < 2^n$, and $h = 2q + s_2(r)$. By Lemma 3.2, $\Phi(n, k, \ell) = n + 2(k - 1) - h$, and $m = \sum_{a=1}^h 2^{b_a}$ with $b_a \leq n - 1$ for all a . Since every part is at least one, $h \leq m \leq k - 1$, and $2^{b_a} \leq m$ gives $b_a < k$.

Suppose that $\deg P \leq \Phi(n, k, \ell) - 1$. Take $K = k$, so $2^K \geq k$, an expansion of P (Lemma 4.2), and $w = P(\hat{x})$ as in Lemma 4.3. Form $E_j^{(t)}$ from this w .

Step 1: the conditions (C_t) . For $0 \leq t < k$ and $T \subseteq \sigma$ with $|T| + 2t \leq h$,

$$\left(w \prod_{i \in T} \hat{x}_i\right)_{k-1-t} = 0.$$

First let $S \subseteq \sigma$ with $|S| + 2t \leq h$, and $\varepsilon = \sigma \setminus S$. A monomial y^e with $|e| = k - 1 - t$ in A_ε would have $|\varepsilon| + 2|e| = n - |S| + 2(k - 1) - 2t \geq n + 2(k - 1) - h > \deg P$, contradicting Lemma 4.2. So $(A_\varepsilon)_{k-1-t} = 0$, and Lemma 4.3 gives $(w \prod_{i \in S} (1 + \hat{x}_i))_{k-1-t} = 0$. Expanding $\prod_{i \in S} (1 + \hat{x}_i) = \sum_{T \subseteq S} \prod_{i \in T} \hat{x}_i$, and using that every $T \subseteq S$ also satisfies $|T| + 2t \leq h$, induction on $|S|$ gives the claim for $T = S$.

Step 2: vanishing on the span. We show, by induction on j and for all t at once, that $E_j^{(t)}(y_{i_1}, \dots, y_{i_j}) = 0$ for all $i_1, \dots, i_j \in \sigma$ whenever $j + 2t \leq h$. Then $t \leq h/2 < k$.

- If the indices are distinct, this is Step 1 with $T = \{i_1, \dots, i_j\}$, by Lemma 4.5(2). This covers $j \leq 1$.
- Otherwise, by symmetry, the tuple is (y_i, y_i, Z) , and by Lemma 4.5(3) the value is $E_{j-1}^{(t)}(y_i, Z) + y_i E_{j-2}^{(t+1)}(Z)$. Both terms vanish by induction, since $(j-1) + 2t \leq h$ and $(j-2) + 2(t+1) \leq h$.

Let $V = \{\sum_{i \in U} y_i : U \subseteq \sigma\}$, the $\mathbb{F}_2$ -span of the variables, with $|V| = 2^n$. By additivity (Lemma 4.5(1)), $E_h^{(0)}$ vanishes on V^h .

Step 3: reduction. Apply Lemma 4.7 with $D = \mathbb{F}_2[y_\sigma]$, this V , $I = \{0, \dots, k-1\}^h$, $c_\tau = w_{k-1-\sum_a 2^{\tau_a}}$, $d_{\tau,a} = 2^{\tau_a}$, and $e_a = 2^{b_a} < 2^n$. It gives

$$\sum_{\tau} w_{k-1-\sum_a 2^{\tau_a}} \prod_a [Y^{2^{b_a}}] \rho_{2^{\tau_a}} = 0.$$

Since L_V is monic of degree 2^n , $\rho_N = Y^N$ for $N < 2^n$.

- If $\tau_a < b_a$ for some a , then $\rho_{2^{\tau_a}} = Y^{2^{\tau_a}}$ has no $Y^{2^{b_a}}$ term, and the term vanishes.
- If $\tau_a \geq b_a$ for all a and $\tau \neq b$, then $\sum_a 2^{\tau_a} > m$, so the index $k-1-\sum_a 2^{\tau_a}$ is below ℓ , and w has no such component by Lemma 4.4.
- For $\tau = b$, $\rho_{2^{b_a}} = Y^{2^{b_a}}$, and the term is $w_{k-1-m} = w_\ell$.

So $w_\ell = 0$, contradicting Lemma 4.4. □

In the construction, each block of 2^n in m is paid by a factor F^2 ; correspondingly, each block contributes two parts 2^{n-1} to the decomposition of m used in this proof.

5 Proof of the main results

Proof of Theorem 1.2. Theorem 3.8 gives a polynomial with the required multiplicities and degree at most $\Phi(n, k, \ell)$, and Theorem 4.8 shows that every such polynomial has degree at least $\Phi(n, k, \ell)$. So the constructed polynomial has degree exactly $\Phi(n, k, \ell)$. $\square$

Lemma 5.1 (The minimum over the origin order). *For $n \geq 1$ and $k \geq 1$, $\min_{0 \leq \ell < k} \Phi(n, k, \ell)$ equals $2k + n - 2 - \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor$ for $k < 2^{n-1}$, and $2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$ for $k \geq 2^{n-1}$ [Lean: this proof] [Lean: via Appendix A].*

Proof. Write $m = k - \ell - 1 = q2^n + r$ as before and $h(m) = 2q + s_2(r)$. By Lemma 3.2, $\Phi = n + 2k - 2 - h(m)$, so the minimum is $n + 2k - 2 - \max_{0 \leq m \leq k-1} h(m)$. Write $k - 1 = Q2^n + R$ with $0 \leq R < 2^n$. Let $\lambda = \lfloor \log_2(R + 1) \rfloor$. The largest digit sum among $0, \dots, R$ is λ : it is attained at $2^\lambda - 1 \leq R$, and every number up to R is below $2^{\lambda+1} - 1$, so it has at most λ binary ones. With $q = Q$ the best value of h is $2Q + \lambda$. With $q \leq Q - 1$, possible only if $Q \geq 1$, it is at most $2Q - 2 + n$, attained at $m = Q2^n - 1$.

- If $Q = 0$, that is $k \leq 2^n$, the minimum is $n + 2k - 2 - \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor$. This is the first case when $k < 2^{n-1}$. For $2^{n-1} \leq k < 2^n$ it is $2k - 1$, and for $k = 2^n$ it is $2k - 2$; both equal $2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$.
- If $Q \geq 1$, then $k = Q2^n + (R + 1)$ with $1 \leq R + 1 \leq 2^n$, and $\lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor = 2Q + \lfloor (R + 1)/2^{n-1} \rfloor$. Moreover $\max(\lambda, n - 2) = n - 2 + \lfloor (R + 1)/2^{n-1} \rfloor$ in each of the three ranges $R + 1 < 2^{n-1}$, $2^{n-1} \leq R + 1 < 2^n$ and $R + 1 = 2^n$ (for $n = 1$ the first is empty). So the minimum is $n + 2k - 2 - 2Q - (n - 2) - \lfloor (R + 1)/2^{n-1} \rfloor = 2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$. $\square$

Proof of Corollary 1.3. Since $D(n, k) = \min_\ell \delta(n, k, \ell)$, Theorem 1.2 and Lemma 5.1 give the value. By Proposition A.2, or directly from the value, every k -admissible polynomial has degree at least $2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$. So a polynomial of exactly this degree exists if and only if $D(n, k)$ equals it. Compare the two in three cases.

- If $k \geq 2^{n-1}$, they are equal.
- If $2^{n-2} \leq k < 2^{n-1}$, then $\lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor = n - 2$ and $\lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor = 0$, so both equal $2k$.
- If $k < 2^{n-2}$, then $n \geq 3$, $\lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor \leq n - 3$ and $\lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor = 0$, so $D(n, k) \geq 2k + 1$. $\square$

Corollary 5.2. *For $n \geq 1$ and $1 \leq k < 3 \cdot 2^{n-1}$, $D(n, k) = 2k + n - 2 - \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor$ [Lean].*

Proof. For $k < 2^{n-1}$ this is Corollary 1.3. Otherwise compare with $2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$.

- If $2^{n-1} \leq k < 2^n$, then $\lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor = n - 1$ and $\lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor = 1$, so both expressions equal $2k - 1$.
- If $2^n \leq k < 3 \cdot 2^{n-1}$, then $\lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor = n$ and $\lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor = 2$, so both equal $2k - 2$. $\square$

At $k = 3 \cdot 2^{n-1}$ the logarithmic expression is $2k - 2$, while $D(n, k) = 2k - 3$.

Remark 5.3 (Which origin orders are extremal). The orders ℓ attaining $D(n, k)$ are those for which $k - \ell - 1 = q2^n + r$ maximizes $2q + s_2(r)$. For $k \leq 2^n$ they are the ℓ with $s_2(k - \ell - 1) = \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor$, for instance $\ell = k - 2^{\lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor}$ [Lean].

Fields of characteristic two

The values of Theorem 1.2 and Corollary 1.3 hold over every field of characteristic two, by a descent to $\mathbb{F}_2$. Definition 2.1 makes sense over any commutative ring, and the descent works in that generality. For a commutative ring R of characteristic two, $\mathbb{F}_2 \subseteq R$, and for an additive map $\varphi: R \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_2$ and $P \in R[x_\sigma]$ let $P^\varphi \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$ be obtained by applying φ to every coefficient.

Lemma 5.4 (Descent). *Let R be a commutative ring of characteristic two, $\varphi: R \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_2$ additive, $P \in R[x_\sigma]$ and $a \in \mathbb{F}_2^\sigma$. Every coefficient of $P^\varphi(a + z)$ is the image under φ of the corresponding coefficient of $P(a + z)$, and $\deg P^\varphi \leq \deg P$ [Lean].*

Proof. Write $P = \sum_u c_u x^u$. Since a has entries in $\mathbb{F}_2$, each $(a + z)^u$ has coefficients $t_{u,\gamma} \in \mathbb{F}_2$, and the coefficient of z^γ in $P(a + z)$ is $\sum_u c_u t_{u,\gamma}$. For $t \in \{0, 1\}$, $\varphi(ct) = t\varphi(c)$, so φ maps this coefficient to $\sum_u \varphi(c_u) t_{u,\gamma}$, the coefficient of z^γ in $P^\varphi(a + z)$. A monomial with coefficient zero in P has coefficient $\varphi(0) = 0$ in P^φ , so the degree does not increase. $\square$

Theorem 5.5 (Every field of characteristic two). *Let R be a field of characteristic two, or more generally a commutative ring of characteristic two, $n \geq 1$ and $0 \leq \ell < k$. The least degree of $P \in R[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ with $\text{mult}_a(P) \geq k$ for every $a \in \{0, 1\}^n \setminus \{\mathbf{0}\}$ and $\text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(P) = \ell$ is $\Phi(n, k, \ell)$. For $k \geq 1$, the least degree of such a P with $\text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(P) \leq k - 1$ is the value $D(n, k)$ of Corollary 1.3 [Lean].*

Proof. The polynomial of Theorem 3.8, read in $R[x]$, has the same Hasse coefficients at the points of $\{0, 1\}^n$ and the same degree, because $\mathbb{F}_2 \rightarrow R$ is injective; so the value Φ is attained. Conversely, let P have multiplicity at least k at the nonzero points and origin order ℓ . Then $P \neq 0$, and some coefficient c of $P(z)$ of degree ℓ is nonzero. As an $\mathbb{F}_2$ -vector space R has an additive map $\varphi: R \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_2$ with $\varphi(c) \neq 0$. By Lemma 5.4, P^φ has multiplicity at least k at the nonzero points, its coefficients of degree below ℓ at the origin vanish, and its coefficient at the monomial of c is $\varphi(c) \neq 0$; so $\text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(P^\varphi) = \ell$. By Theorem 1.2, $\deg P \geq \deg P^\varphi \geq \Phi(n, k, \ell)$. The statement about $D(n, k)$ follows by minimizing over $\ell < k$ with Lemma 5.1. $\square$

Remark 5.6 (Other fields and grids). The proofs of Sections 3 and 4 use characteristic two throughout: the expansion in $x^\varepsilon(x^2 + x)^\varepsilon$ with squarefree x^ε , the additivity of $Y \mapsto Y^{2^j}$, the two shifts $\gamma_i \in \{0, 1\}$ in Lemma 4.3, and the telescoping identity. The natural next questions are the least degree at every origin order over fields of odd characteristic and characteristic zero below Menezes' range $n \geq k - 1$, and the analogue on grids other than $\{0, 1\}^n$.

How this paper was produced

The results were developed in a public research notebook [Notebook], whose dated entries record the exact computations that suggested the formulas, the failed routes and the reviews, using *Noemesis*, an open framework for AI-assisted mathematical research distributed with the repository [Repo]. Proposition A.2 was drafted with GPT-6 Astra in the Codex agent [Note]. The rest of the mathematics, the Lean formalization and the draft of this paper were produced by Claude Opus 5.5 in Claude Code under the author's direction, and fresh-context Claude reviewers checked the informal arguments. The author chose the problem, directed the investigation and designed the framework. The paper has not been externally peer reviewed; formal verification covers the statements mapped in Appendix B, not the prose or the comparison with the literature. Version 1 of this paper (24 September 2026) contained the value of $D(n, k)$ with the proof of Appendix A; version 2 adds

the value at every origin order. Original manuscript material is distributed under the [CC BY 4.0](#) license.

A A second proof of the value of $D(n, k)$

This appendix gives a second proof of Corollary 1.3, the one of version 1 of this paper. It does not use Section 4, and it does not determine $\delta(n, k, \ell)$ for individual orders. Its lower bound combines the multiplicity Schwartz–Zippel lemma with a one-dimension reduction; the upper bound is Proposition 3.9 for $k < 2^{n-1}$ and the hyperplane covers (Remark A.9) for $k \geq 2^{n-1}$.

A.1 The Schwartz–Zippel bound

The only result used here without proof is the multiplicity Schwartz–Zippel lemma.

Theorem A.1 (Multiplicity Schwartz–Zippel [DKSS13, Lemma 2.7]). *Let $\mathbb{F}$ be a field, σ a nonempty finite set, $P \in \mathbb{F}[x_\sigma]$ a nonzero polynomial and $S \subseteq \mathbb{F}$ a finite set. Then*

$$\sum_{a \in S^\sigma} \text{mult}_a(P) \leq \deg P \cdot |S|^{|\sigma|-1}$$

[Lean].

Proposition A.2. *Let $n \geq 1$ and $k \geq 0$. Every nonzero $P \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ with $\text{mult}_a(P) \geq k$ for all $a \neq \mathbf{0}$ satisfies*

$$\deg P \geq 2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$$

[Lean]. *In particular this holds for every k -admissible P .*

Proof. Put $d = \deg P$ and $M = 2^{n-1}$. The $2^n - 1$ nonzero points contribute at least $k(2^n - 1)$ to $\sum_{a \in \mathbb{F}_2^n} \text{mult}_a(P)$, and Theorem A.1 with $S = \mathbb{F}_2$ bounds this sum by dM . So $k(2M - 1) \leq dM$.

Let $c = \lfloor k/M \rfloor$, and suppose $d + c < 2k$. Then $dM + (c + 1)M \leq 2kM$. Since $(c + 1)M > k$, this gives $dM < 2kM - k = k(2M - 1)$, a contradiction. $\square$

This is the deduction of the earlier note [Note], stated without the restriction $k \geq 2^{n-2}$ of [BDDM23, Question 4.3]. As the note observed, the origin condition is used only to exclude $P = 0$.

A.2 Linear substitutions

For a matrix $A \in \mathbb{F}^{\sigma \times \sigma}$ over any field, let $P \mapsto P \circ A$ be the algebra map with $x_i \mapsto \sum_j A_{ij}x_j$. The same matrix acts on points by $(Aa)_i = \sum_j A_{ij}a_j$.

Lemma A.3. *Let $A, B \in \mathbb{F}^{\sigma \times \sigma}$ and $P \in \mathbb{F}[x_\sigma]$.*

1. *If P is homogeneous of degree d , so is $P \circ A$. Hence $P \mapsto P \circ A$ commutes with taking homogeneous components, and $\deg(P \circ A) \leq \deg P$.*
2. *$(P \circ A) \circ B = P \circ (AB)$.*
3. *If A is invertible, then $\text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(P \circ A) = \text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(P)$ and $\text{mult}_a(P \circ A) = \text{mult}_{Aa}(P)$ for every a .*

[Lean]

Proof. Part 1 holds because each x_i goes to a linear form. Part 2 can be checked on the variables. For part 3, by part 2 an invertible A gives an injective substitution. The origin order is the least j with a nonzero homogeneous component of degree j , and by part 1 this is preserved.

For the second claim, the shift commutes with substitution: $(P \circ A)(a + z) = P(Aa + Az) = (P(Aa + z)) \circ A$. So $\text{mult}_a(P \circ A) = \text{mult}_0(P(Aa + z) \circ A) = \text{mult}_0(P(Aa + z)) = \text{mult}_{Aa}(P)$. $\square$

Lemma A.4. Write $\lambda_v = \sum_i v_i x_i$ for the linear form of a vector v .

1. Let $L \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$ be nonzero with $\deg L < 2^{|\sigma|} - 1$. Then $\lambda_v \nmid L$ for some nonzero $v \in \mathbb{F}_2^\sigma$.
2. Over any field $\mathbb{F}$, for every nonzero $v \in \mathbb{F}^\sigma$ and every $i_0 \in \sigma$ there is an invertible A with $\lambda_v \circ A = x_{i_0}$.

[Lean]

Proof. (1) The ring $\mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$ is a unique factorization domain. Each nonzero λ_v has degree one, so it is irreducible, hence prime. The only unit of $\mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$ is 1, so distinct forms are not associated. Distinct vectors give distinct forms. If all $2^{|\sigma|} - 1$ nonzero forms divided L , their product would divide L , forcing $\deg L \geq 2^{|\sigma|} - 1$.

(2) By definition $\lambda_v \circ A = \lambda_{vA}$, with vA the row vector v times A . Extend the isomorphism between the lines $\mathbb{F}v$ and $\mathbb{F}e_{i_0}$ that sends v to e_{i_0} to a linear automorphism g of $\mathbb{F}^\sigma$, and let A be the transpose of the matrix of g . Then $vA = g(v) = e_{i_0}$. $\square$

A.3 The one-dimension step

Write the variable set as $\sigma \cup \{x_0\}$ and a point as (c, a') with $c \in \mathbb{F}_2$ and $a' \in \mathbb{F}_2^\sigma$. For $Q \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_0, x_\sigma]$ and $c \in \mathbb{F}_2$, let $Q(c, x') \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$ denote the substitution $x_0 = c$.

Lemma A.5. For all Q , c and a' , $\text{mult}_{a'}(Q(c, x')) \geq \text{mult}_{(c, a')}(Q)$ [Lean].

Proof. The shift of $Q(c, x')$ at a' is $Q((c, a') + (z_0, z'))$ with $z_0 = 0$. Its coefficients are the coefficients of $Q((c, a') + (z_0, z'))$ at monomials without z_0 , and these have the same degree. $\square$

Theorem A.6 (One-dimension step). Let σ be a finite set, $n = |\sigma| + 1$ and $k < 2^n$. Let $P \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_0, x_\sigma]$ satisfy $\text{mult}_a(P) \geq k$ for every nonzero point a and $\text{mult}_0(P) < k$. Then there is $S \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$ with $\text{mult}_{a'}(S) \geq k$ for every nonzero a' , with $\text{mult}_0(S) = \text{mult}_0(P)$, and with

$$\deg S + 1 \leq \deg P$$

[Lean].

Proof. Let $\ell = \text{mult}_0(P) < k$ and let $L \neq 0$ be the homogeneous component of P of degree ℓ .

Choosing coordinates. We have $\deg L = \ell \leq k - 1 < 2^n - 1$, so Lemma A.4 gives a nonzero form $\lambda_v \nmid L$ and an invertible A with $\lambda_v \circ A = x_0$. Put $Q = P \circ A$. By Lemma A.3:

- Q satisfies the hypotheses, because A permutes the nonzero points;
- $\text{mult}_0(Q) = \ell$ and $\deg Q \leq \deg P$;
- the degree- ℓ component of Q is $L \circ A$;
- $x_0 \nmid L \circ A$: otherwise substituting A^{-1} would give $\lambda_v \mid L$.

The difference. Let $S = Q(0, x') + Q(1, x')$. Write $Q = \sum_{t \geq 0} x_0^t Q_t$ with $Q_t \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_\sigma]$. Then $S = \sum_{t \geq 1} Q_t$, since the $t = 0$ terms cancel in characteristic two.

- *Nonzero points.* For $a' \neq \mathbf{0}$, both $(0, a')$ and $(1, a')$ are nonzero, so Lemma A.5 and Lemma 2.2(2) give $\text{mult}_{a'}(S) \geq k$.
- *Origin order, lower bound.* Lemma A.5 gives $\text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(Q(0, x')) \geq \ell$, and $\text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(Q(1, x')) \geq k$ because $(1, \mathbf{0}) \neq \mathbf{0}$. So $\text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(S) \geq \ell$.
- *Origin order, upper bound.* The constant term of $L \circ A$ in x_0 , namely $(L \circ A)(0, x')$, is nonzero because $x_0 \nmid L \circ A$. Take a monomial $(x')^\beta$ with a nonzero coefficient in it. Then $|\beta| = \ell$, and the same coefficient appears in $Q(0, x')$. The coefficient of $(x')^\beta$ in $Q(1, x')$ vanishes, because $\ell < k \leq \text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(Q(1, x'))$. So $(x')^\beta$ occurs in S , and $\text{mult}_{\mathbf{0}}(S) \leq \ell$. In particular $S \neq 0$.
- *Degree.* Since $S \neq 0$ and $\deg Q_t + t \leq \deg Q$ for every $t \geq 1$, $\deg S \leq \deg Q - 1$.

Finally $\deg S + 1 \leq \deg Q \leq \deg P$. □

Remark A.7. In particular $D(n-1, k) \leq D(n, k) - 1$ for $n \geq 2$ and $k < 2^n$, and, since the origin order is kept exactly, the same holds for δ . By Corollary 1.3 and Theorem 1.2, both inequalities hold for every $k \geq 1$ [Lean: D] [Lean: δ].

A.4 The lower bound

Theorem A.8. *Let $k \geq 1$ and $n \geq \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor + 2$. Every k -admissible $P \in \mathbb{F}_2[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ satisfies*

$$\deg P \geq 2k + n - 2 - \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor$$

[Lean].

Proof. Let $n_0 = \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor + 2$, so $k < 2^{n_0-1}$. Argue by induction on $n \geq n_0$.

For $n = n_0$, Proposition A.2 gives $\deg P \geq 2k - \lfloor k/2^{n_0-1} \rfloor = 2k$, which is the claim.

For $n+1 > n_0$, identify the variables with $\{x_0\} \cup \sigma$, where $|\sigma| = n$. This relabelling preserves degree, and by Lemma 2.2(5) it preserves multiplicities at the relabelled points. Since $k < 2^{n_0-1} \leq 2^{n+1}$, Theorem A.6 gives a k -admissible S in n variables with $\deg S + 1 \leq \deg P$. The induction hypothesis bounds $\deg S$. □

A.5 The value of $D(n, k)$

Remark A.9 (Hyperplane covers [BBDM23, Theorem 1.2(a) with $d = 1$]). Let $n \geq 1$ and $k \geq 2^{n-1}$, and write $k = c2^{n-1} + b$ with $0 \leq b < 2^{n-1}$. Then $P = F^c \cdot (x_1^2 + x_1)^b$ is k -admissible and $\deg P \leq 2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$ [Lean]. This is the polynomial form of a cover of Bishnoi et al. by c copies of the $2^n - 1$ hyperplanes avoiding the origin and b copies of the pair $x_1 = 0, x_1 = 1$, and it follows from Lemma 3.7: the multiplicity at a nonzero point is at least $c2^{n-1} + b = k$, the origin order is $b < k$, and the degree is at most $c(2^n - 1) + 2b = 2k - c$.

Theorem A.10 (Second proof of the value of $D(n, k)$). *For all $n \geq 1$ and $k \geq 1$, $D(n, k)$ takes the values of Corollary 1.3. More precisely:*

1. for $n \geq \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor + 2$, equivalently $k < 2^{n-1}$, every k -admissible P has $\deg P \geq 2k + n - 2 - \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor$;

2. for every $n \geq 1$, some k -admissible P has $\deg P \leq 2k + n - 2 - \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor$;
3. for $k \geq 2^{n-1}$, $D(n, k) = 2k - \lfloor k/2^{n-1} \rfloor$.

[Lean: parts 1, 2] [Lean: part 3]

Proof. Part 1 is Theorem A.8. For $k \geq 1$, $k < 2^{n-1}$ is equivalent to $\lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor < n - 1$, which is $n \geq \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor + 2$.

For part 2, let $J = \lfloor \log_2 k \rfloor$ and $\ell = k - 2^J < k$, so that $k - \ell - 1 = 2^J - 1$. By Proposition 3.9 the polynomial $y_1^\ell g_{2^J}$ is k -admissible, with degree at most $n + 2k - 2 - s_2(2^J - 1) = n + 2k - 2 - J$ by Lemma 3.1(4).

For part 3, Proposition A.2 gives the lower bound and Remark A.9 the upper bound. $\square$

B Formal-verification map and reproduction

The arguments are complete in the body; reading them requires no Lean. This appendix locates the formal declarations and gives commands to check them. File paths are relative to `formalization/`. The table uses the prefix `MR.` for `MathResearch.`; the external inputs lie under `MathResearch.ThirdParty`.

Paper statement	Lean file and declarations
Hasse multiplicity, Definition 2.1; Lemma 2.2	claims/HasseMultiplicity.lean MR.HasseMultiplicity.mult, coe_le_mult_iff, min_le_mult_add, add_le_mult_mul, mult_mul, mult_eq_zero_iff, mult_rename_equiv
Substitution, Lemma 2.3	claims/PerOrderArithmetic.lean MR.PerOrderArithmetic.mult_le_mult_zero_subst
Digit sums, Lemma 3.1	claims/TruncatedProduct.lean MR.TruncatedProduct.s2_add_le, s2_two_pow, s2_le_self, two_mul_add_s2_le; MR.BinaryMultiplicityDegreeFormula.s2_two_pow_sub_one
Legendre form, Lemma 3.2	claims/PerOrderLegendre.lean MR.PerOrderLegendre.legendre, phi_of_lt_two_pow, bits, length_bits, sum_bits, lt_of_mem_bits
Digit-sum identities used in the remarks	claims/BinaryDigitSums.lean MR.BinaryDigitSums.s2_mul_two_pow_add, two_pow_s2_le, s2_le_log, s2_pos, s2_eq_one_iff, s2_succ_add_padicValNat
Catalan parity [AK73, DS06], Lemma 3.5	third-party-claims/CatalanParity.lean MR.ThirdParty.CatalanParity.padicValNat_catalan, odd_catalan_iff
Telescoping, Lemma 3.3; truncated product, Theorem 3.6	claims/TruncatedProduct.lean MR.TruncatedProduct.telescope, g, truncated_product
Hyperplane product, Lemma 3.7; construction, Theorem 3.8	claims/PerOrderUpperBound.lean MR.PerOrderUpperBound.hypProd, mult_hypProd, eval_zero_hypProd, totalDegree_hypProd, Phi, construction, construction_spec, per_order_upper_bound
Menezes' polynomial, Proposition 3.9	claims/PerOrderConstruction.lean MR.PerOrderConstruction.per_order_construction

Paper statement	Lean file and declarations
Expansion, Lemma 4.2	claims/PerOrderExpansion.lean MR.PerOrderExpansion.exists_expansion, weight_le_totalDegree
Local inverse, Lemma 4.1	claims/PerOrderYCoefficient.lean MR.PerOrderYCoefficient.xhat_sq_add; claims/ArtinSchreierSeries.lean MR.ArtinSchreierSeries.asRoot, coeff_asRoot_eq_one_iff, asRoot_sq_add, trunc_asRoot
Congruence, Lemma 4.3	claims/PerOrderYCoefficient.lean MR.PerOrderYCoefficient.xhat, xhat_sq_add, expansion_congr, coeff_expansion
Forms, Lemma 4.5	claims/PerOrderForms.lean MR.PerOrderForms.E, E_perm, E_span, E_eval, E_rec
Grid vanishing, Lemma 4.6; grid reduction, Lemma 4.7	Mathlib.MvPolynomial.eq_zero_of_eval_zero_at_prod_finset; claims/PerOrderSubspaceReduction.lean MR.PerOrderSubspaceReduction.rho, coeff_reduction
Lowest part, Lemma 4.4; lower bound, Theorem 4.8	claims/PerOrderLowerBound.lean MR.PerOrderLowerBound.wser, mult_wser, hc_wser_ne, cond, E_vanish, lower_bound
Main theorem, Theorem 1.2	claims/PerOrderValue.lean MR.PerOrderValue.per_order_value
Minimum over the origin order, Lemma 5.1; extremal orders, Remark 5.3	claims/PerOrderMinimumDirect.lean MR.PerOrderMinimumDirect.hval, hval_le, hval_attain, min_phi_direct, phi_eq_degreeMin_iff, extremal_of_le_two_pow, extremal_example, delta_eq_D_iff, delta_eq_D_of_le_two_pow, delta_extremal_example; claims/PerOrderMinimum.lean MR.PerOrderMinimum.min_phi
Arithmetic of Φ and δ in the prose: Section 1 (Legendre form, comparison with Menezes' form, blocks, examples, the top order, the reals, $n = 1$), Section 3 (exact degree, the factors of F and of F^2), Remark A.7	claims/PerOrderArithmetic.lean MR.PerOrderArithmetic.phi_add_eq, phi_lt_menezes, construction_lt_menezes, phi_add_block, phi_of_le, phi_of_real_range, phi_top, phi_succ, totalDegree_construction, menezes_form_optimal, one_le_s2, example_one, cube_example, example_two, card_nonzero, mult_hypProd_sq, totalDegree_hypProd_sq; for δ itself: deltaSet, isLeast_deltaSet, delta_succ, delta_of_real_range, delta_top, delta_examples, delta_one
Arithmetic of $D(n, k)$ in the prose: Sections 1 and 5, Remark A.7; admissible polynomials are nonzero	claims/DegreeFormulaArithmetic.lean MR.DegreeFormulaArithmetic.degreeMin_one, degreeMin_four, degreeMin_eight, degreeMin_fifteen, degreeMin_excess, degreeMin_succ, degreeMin_three_mul, degreeMin_add_one_le; for D itself: degreeSet, isLeast_degreeSet, admissible_ne_zero, D_examples, D_excess, D_succ, D_three_mul, D_add_one_le
Descent, Lemma 5.4; characteristic two, Theorem 5.5	claims/PerOrderCharTwo.lean MR.PerOrderCharTwo.coeffMap, coeff_shift_coeffMap, totalDegree_coeffMap_le, lower_bound_char_two, per_order_value_char_two, degree_complete_char_two

Paper statement	Lean file and declarations
Value of $D(n, k)$, Corollary 1.3; Theorem A.10(3)	claims/BinaryMultiplicityDegreeComplete.lean MR.BinaryMultiplicityDegreeComplete.degreeMin, degree_complete, cover_bound_attained_iff
Extended range, Corollary 5.2	claims/BinaryMultiplicityDegreeExtendedRange.lean MR.BinaryMultiplicityDegreeExtendedRange.degree_formula_ extended
Multiplicity Schwartz–Zippel [DKSS13], Theorem A.1	third-party-claims/MultiplicitySchwartzZippel.lean MR.ThirdParty.MultiplicitySchwartzZippel.multiplicity_ schwartz_zippel
Schwartz–Zippel bound over $\mathbb{F}_2$, Proposition A.2	claims/BinaryMultiplicityCoverBound.lean MR.BinaryMultiplicityCoverBound.cover_bound, cover_bound_of_origin
Linear substitutions, Lemma A.3; restriction, Lemma A.5	claims/OneDimensionStep.lean MR.OneDimensionStep.homogeneousComponent_subst, totalDegree_subst_le, subst_comp, mult_zero_subst, mult_subst, mult_restrict
Avoiding a linear form, Lemma A.4	claims/LinearFormAvoidance.lean MR.LinearFormAvoidance.exists_linForm_not_dvd, exists_subst_linForm_eq_X
One-dimension step, Theorem A.6	claims/OneDimensionStep.lean MR.OneDimensionStep.one_dimension_step
Lower bound, Theorem A.8	claims/BinaryMultiplicityLowerBound.lean MR.BinaryMultiplicityLowerBound.lower_bound
Hyperplane covers [BBDM23], Remark A.9	third-party-claims/HyperplaneCoverUpperBound.lean MR.ThirdParty.HyperplaneCoverUpperBound.hyperplane_cover_ upper_bound, card_dot_eq_one
Second proof, Theorem A.10(1,2); Definition 1.1	claims/BinaryMultiplicityDegreeFormula.lean MR.BinaryMultiplicityDegreeFormula.Admissible, degree_formula, degree_formula_exact, degree_formula_of_lt_two_pow

Reading the formal statements.

- Points are functions $\text{Fin } n \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}\text{Mod } 2$, degree is `MvPolynomial.totalDegree`, and multiplicity is `MR.HasseMultiplicity.mult`, the order of $P(a+z)$ in $\mathbb{N}_\infty$. Φ is `MR.PerOrderUpperBound.Phi`, written out with natural-number division.
- Section 4 uses one polynomial ring for both x and y : $A_\varepsilon(x^2 + x)$ is `aeval yv (A ε)`. The series $\hat{x}_K$ is `xhat K`, and w is `wser k P`, with $K = k$.
- In `MR.PerOrderForms.E`, the coefficient $w_{k-1-t-\Sigma}$ is written `hcw k w (t + Σ)`, which is zero when $t + \Sigma \geq k$.
- In `MR.TruncatedProduct.g` the pair (S, p) of Definition 3.4 is encoded by a map $c : \sigma \rightarrow \{\perp, 0, \dots, s-1\}$: $c_i = \perp$ means $i \notin S$, and $c_i = j$ means $p_i = 2^j$. The sum runs over maps of cost $\sum_{c_i \neq \perp} 2^{c_i} \leq s-1$, and the bound $j < s$ is automatic, because $2^j \leq s-1 < 2^s$. The Lean statements hold for every $s \geq 0$ with natural-number subtraction.

- The Lean proof of Theorem A.1 follows the induction on the number of variables in [DKSS13] (Lemma 8 of the arXiv version). It also proves the scaled form $|S| \sum_a \text{mult}_a(P) \leq \deg P \cdot |S|^{|\sigma|}$, which holds with no variables.
- Lemma 5.1 has two Lean proofs. The first follows the digit argument of Section 5. The second derives the minimum from Theorem 1.2 and the value of $D(n, k)$ proved in Appendix A: every $\Phi(n, k, \ell)$ is the degree of a k -admissible polynomial, and the origin order of a k -admissible polynomial of least degree attains the minimum.
- The one-dimension step is stated for the variables Option σ , with none playing the role of x_0 . The lower bound of Appendix A relabels $\text{Fin}(n + 1)$ as $\text{Option}(\text{Fin } n)$.

Commands. The project pins Lean 4.34.0-rc2 and Mathlib in `lakefile.lean` and `lake-manifest.json`. With `elan`, Git and Python 3 installed:

```
git clone https://github.com/kbr-/math-research.git bmd-check
cd bmd-check
git checkout --detach 7fc6175b92fd064c488eca76eba2b04522da7815
cd formalization
export MATHLIB_NO_CACHE_ON_UPDATE=1
lake exe cache get claims/BinaryMultiplicityDegreePaper2.lean
python3 verify.py --target claims/BinaryMultiplicityDegreePaper2.lean \
  --out verification.txt
```

The target is an import-only module whose header lists 69 declarations: the main ones (`per_order_value`, `construction_spec`, both `lower_bound` theorems, `min_phi`, `min_phi_direct`, `degree_complete`, `cover_bound_attained_iff`, `per_order_construction`) and those behind the remarks and comparisons. It imports every module in the table, so the build covers the whole chain, and its axiom report is transitive. The verifier builds the proofs, prints each listed declaration's type, and rejects unfinished proofs and nonstandard axioms. The expected axiom report for the main theorem is

```
'MathResearch.PerOrderValue.per_order_value'
depends on axioms: [propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]
```

and the same for every other listed declaration. These are Lean's standard foundations.

Kernel replay. To recheck the compiled proofs, and every imported declaration including Mathlib's, in a fresh Lean kernel, run

```
lake env leanchecker --fresh claims.BinaryMultiplicityDegreePaper2
from formalization/.
```

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